

THEATRICAL PRESENTATIONS

Loudoun County Public Schools (LCPS) administrative guidelines are designed to support theatre presentations that challenge, nurture, and extend students' skills while adhering to the basic educational mission of teaching students boundaries of socially appropriate behavior, the rights and responsibilities of the exercise of free speech, and the importance of taking into consideration the sensibilities of the community. The theatre director or sponsor has the primary responsibility, and the principal has the final authority for ensuring that this policy is followed.

A. Protocol. To ensure that these criteria are met, drama sponsors should follow this protocol:

1. The theatre director or sponsor will present a proposed play to the principal at least three weeks before any auditions are held or technical crews chosen. The final decision regarding a play's production will not be announced to the student body until it has been cleared by the principal.

2. When the theatre director or sponsor presents a proposal to the principal, a discussion will be held as to the play's appropriateness. The discussion should allow consideration of:

- a. the educational value of producing the play;
- b. whether modes of expression could be harmful to minors;
- c. whether thematic content of the play is appropriate for the target audience.

3. The version of a script presented to the principal is the version to be performed. If modifications are made to an established script, they will be presented to the principal before the script is approved.

4. If the play is written by a student, the script must be completed before it is submitted for review. If modifications to a student script are made, the principal will be informed of these modifications so that they may be reviewed prior to the performance.

5. A principal may convene an advisory panel to discuss a play. If the work is student-generated, the student may be added to this panel. This will be an advisory panel only. The principal will make the final decision on the play's production.

6. Once a play has been approved by the principal for production, the principal and theatre director or sponsor will sign the Theatre Production Approval form, located in the Theatre Handbook. The principal and theatre director or sponsor will retain a copy of the completed approval form.

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7. The theatre director or sponsor will post a brief summary of the play on the school's website.

8. Drama productions presented publicly will be videotaped unless prohibited by copyright law. All performances of student-written plays will be videotaped.

9. All play programs, including artwork, will be submitted for the principal's review.

[Former Regulation 8-42]

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